

They had the trademark reserved since more than five years. Apple fans and blogs all around the world were effectively shut up when they realised that even if Apple did release a phone, it wasn't going to be branded an iPhone.

There were controversial statements with some people hating the idea of

Apple calling their phone the iPhone, and others angered at the prospect of having to address Apple's rumoured phone with some other name. Alternative names were suggested by people all over the web such as iFone, MacMobile, TelePod, iMobile, PodPhone, iChat Mobile or even iMistake (clearly, this guy was not a huge fan of Apple)!



Cisco beat Apple to the iPhone brand, causing much confusion

If the news of Cisco owning the rights to the iPhone trademark was surprising for people, the announcement of Apple christening their new phone as the iPhone was a total shocker. Steve Jobs had the gall to stand in front of four thousand people and announce a product to the world with a name that was trademarked by another company! Speculation ran high again as people wondered that it wasn't quite possible that Jobs had made the decision without being absolutely certain that they'd win the trademark in some way. If they would have had to rename the phone to something else later and pay Cisco charges for damage, it would have been a humiliation for the company.

However, Apple has a history of choosing controversial names and getting away with them. The name Macintosh was similar to the name of a product of a music company, McIntosh. Apple should not have gotten the rights to the name because both were pronounced exactly the same, but Apple somehow got the trade-